## Conversation track 8, 10, 11

*It's day five of non-stop rain on Hamish and Imogen's beach trip.*

Hamish: Well, it's looking **a bit damp** out there again.

Imogen: A bit damp? The street's basically a river, Hamish!

Hamish: **Not ideal**, I'll admit. But at least the garden's getting a good drink.

Imogen: **Oh, great.** That makes me feel so much better.

Hamish: Look on the bright side. We've finished three jigsaw puzzles.

Imogen: **Living the dream.** I packed four swimsuits for this trip.

Hamish: You could always wear one in the bath.

Imogen: **Very funny.** So is it going to clear up tomorrow?

Hamish: Glorious sunshine, apparently. Though they said that yesterday, too.

Imogen: **Oh, wonderful.** I'll believe it when I see it.

## Study Notes

**Look on the bright side.**
Nhìn vào mặt tích cực đi.
*Dùng để an ủi, hoặc nói đùa khi tình huống chẳng có gì tích cực.*
*Cách nói tương đương: At least it's not all bad.*

**I'll believe it when I see it.**
Thấy tận mắt mới tin.
*Tỏ ý nghi ngờ một lời hứa hay một dự báo.*
*Cách nói tương đương: I'm not holding my breath.*

## Speak Like a Native track 9

**1. Not ideal, I'll admit.**
*strong:* "Not ideal"
*linking:* "I'll‿admit"
Nói giảm kiểu Anh: giọng đều, bình thản như không có gì, dù tình huống khá tệ. "I'll admit" nối thành "ai-lơd-mít".

**2. Oh, great. That makes me feel so much better.**
*strong:* "great", "so much better"
Mỉa mai: "great" đọc thấp, phẳng, kéo dài; "so much better" nhấn quá mức. Nghĩa thật là ngược lại: chẳng thấy khá hơn chút nào.

**3. You could always wear one in the bath.**
*weak:* "could"
*linking:* "one‿in‿the"
*strong:* "always", "bath"
Câu đùa tỉnh bơ: giọng đều, nhấn "always" và "bath". Giọng Anh chuẩn đọc "bath" /bɑːθ/ (a dài), giọng Mỹ đọc /bæθ/.

- Mỉa mai: từ tích cực (great, wonderful) đọc thấp, phẳng, kéo dài; người nghe hiểu nghĩa ngược lại.
- Cùng là "Oh, great!": lên giọng, tươi tắn là khen thật; phẳng, kéo dài là mỉa.
- Nói giảm kiểu Anh (a bit damp, not ideal): giọng bình thản, càng tỉnh càng buồn cười.
- Nói nhanh, "going to" thành "gonna" ("gơ-nơ"): is it gonna clear up?

## Grammar Focus

### Nói giảm (understatement)

*Nói nhẹ đi một tình huống tệ để hài hước hoặc giữ bình tĩnh, rất phổ biến ở người Anh: a bit, not ideal, not the best, could be better.*

Losing your passport abroad is **not ideal**.
My first day was **not the best**, to be honest.
That presentation **could have gone better**.

### Mỉa mai (sarcasm)

*Dùng từ tích cực với ngữ điệu phẳng, kéo dài để nói điều ngược lại.*
*Hay gặp: Great. / Lovely. / Just what I needed. / Yeah, right.*

A flat tire? **Great**. **Just what I needed**.
He'll be on time? **Yeah, right**.
Oh, **brilliant**. The printer's broken again.

## Role Play track 13

A: Well, it's looking a bit damp out there again.

B: A bit damp? The street's basically _____, Hamish!

A: Not ideal, I'll admit. But at least the garden's getting a good drink.

B: Oh, great. That makes me feel so much better.

A: Look on the bright side. We've finished three jigsaw puzzles.

B: _____. I packed four swimsuits for this trip.

A: You could always wear one in the bath.

B: Very funny. So is it going to clear up tomorrow?

A: Glorious sunshine, apparently. Though they said that yesterday, too.

B: _____. I'll believe it when I see it.

## Substitution Drill track 14

1. The street's basically a river, Hamish!
   **a.** a swimming pool
   **b.** a lake
   **c.** underwater

2. Living the dream. I packed four swimsuits for this trip.
   **a.** Best vacation ever
   **b.** This is the life
   **c.** Just my luck

3. Oh, wonderful. I'll believe it when I see it.
   **a.** Yeah, right
   **b.** Oh, sure
   **c.** Fat chance